CLAUDIO MÉNDEZ

Pianist · Composer · Conductor

Like many musicians of his generation, he absorbs the influence of popular music (tango, jazz, folklore, and rock) and fuses it with his classical training. In the 1980s he founded the group Nuevos Aires, acting as composer and pianist. The aesthetics of Nuevos Aires caught the attention of Astor Piazzolla, who gifted them his unpublished piece «500 MOTIVACIONES» and invited them to premiere it when he was named Distinguished Citizen of Buenos Aires.

CARLOS GARDEL AWARD WITH OPUS CUATRO / GÓMEZ-MÉNDEZ DUO / NUEVOS AIRES / SEXTET

In November 2000 he recorded the album «Tangos, Valses y Milongas» with the vocal group Opus Cuatro, receiving the 2001 Carlos Gardel Award for Best Tango Album. That same year he formed a duo with Daniel Gómez. Together they completed eight international tours across Chile, Ecuador, Europe, and the USA, releasing the albums «Tango Nuestro» and «Tangueros». In 2009 they presented «Milonga Cromada» as a quintet at the World Tango Summit in Bariloche, Patagonia. In 2017 he reunited with Nuevos Aires for the Buenos Aires Tango Festival, and in 2023 he recorded a new album of original compositions with the Claudio Méndez Sexteto.

SOLO CAREER

In 1999 he released «Piano, piano...», an album of original works performed in concert halls across Argentina and on tours in England and France. In 2011 he published «Tango & Piano», featuring material from his book Tango Arrangements in Authentic Argentine Style, released in the USA. His album «Pianeros», a tribute to tango and folklore pianists, was created for his performance as closing artist at the 2015 Whidbey Island Tango Festival (Seattle, USA), followed by tours in Spain and France.

PIANIST · PRODUCER · ARRANGER

He has collaborated with Emilio del Guercio, José Ángel Trelles, Adriana Varela, Ariel Prat, Marcelo Balsells, and Nilda Fernández, among others. Since 2013 he has been part of the fado project Luz de lágrima with singer and actress Gabriela González López, recording the albums Fado Secreto and Pessoa, persoa, persona... and performing in Buenos Aires and on four tours in Spain and France. In 2024 he presented «Salgán a Cuatro Manos» at the 36th Granada Tango Festival with pianist Polly Ferman. In October he performed at the Royal Academy of Fine Arts of Galicia. In 2025 he performed at Casa de América Madrid with singer M. Balsells and cellist G. Nardi.

CAREER HIGHLIGHTS

2000–2003

Music Coordinator, Department of Culture, Municipality of Morón.

2006–2009

Music Director, Patagonia y Tango Festival, San Carlos de Bariloche.

2010–2024

Piano and Ensemble Practice Professor, Escuela de Música Popular de Avellaneda (EMPA), Buenos Aires Province.

2011

Publishes Tango Arrangements for Piano in Authentic Argentine Style in the USA.

2015–2023

Choir Director and Associate Conductor, National University of Hurlingham (UNAHUR) Symphony Orchestra.

2017

Reunites Nuevos Aires for a special tribute concert to Astor Piazzolla at the Buenos Aires Tango Festival with Daniel Binelli.

2023

Releases El Susurro de la Luna with his new project, Claudio Méndez Sexteto.